Lifelong Learning 8

8.01 Lifelong Learning 186
8.05 Training and Development 190
8.11 Pathways to Success 196
8.13 Continuing Professional Development 198
8.17 Assessment Task 1a 202

Activities 8: Lifelong Learning		p.	Due date	Done	Comment
8A	**Lifelong learning**	189			
8B	**Training and development**	194-195			
8C	**Pathways to success**	197			
8D	**Continuing professional development**	200			
8E	**Career development - Insights**	201			
AT1a	**Lifelong Learning Plan - My Investigation**	202			

Comments:

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8.01 Lifelong Learning

Multiple career pathways

These days, very few people experience a linear career pathway. Instead people develop multiple **career pathways**.

Most modern pathways branch off in different directions supported by **lifelong learning**. Many people change occupations and develop different careers throughout their working lives. These changes reflect changes in personal **values** associated with the stage of one's life. Sometimes a sideways or even a backwards step can advance a person along their career pathway.

Career life cycle

As people go through different stages of their lives, they will have different **expectations** related to career development. When first starting their careers, people are likely to trade leisure time for income, and usually have limited loyalty to their employer.

As people age and develop through their lives, they might seek out more motivating, rewarding and satisfying jobs. Later in life, people might look to consolidate their careers and strike a balance between work, family and financial security.

In the final stage of their careers people might seek **self-actualisation**, whereby they can fully achieve their potential. This might be in a senior role, or it might be through a 'seachange', 'treechange'; or downshifting to a less lucrative, but more satisfying role.

And of course, the exodus continues of 'fed-up' and 'strung-out' metropolitan professionals leaving stressful roles, and moving to more 'laidback' regional settings!

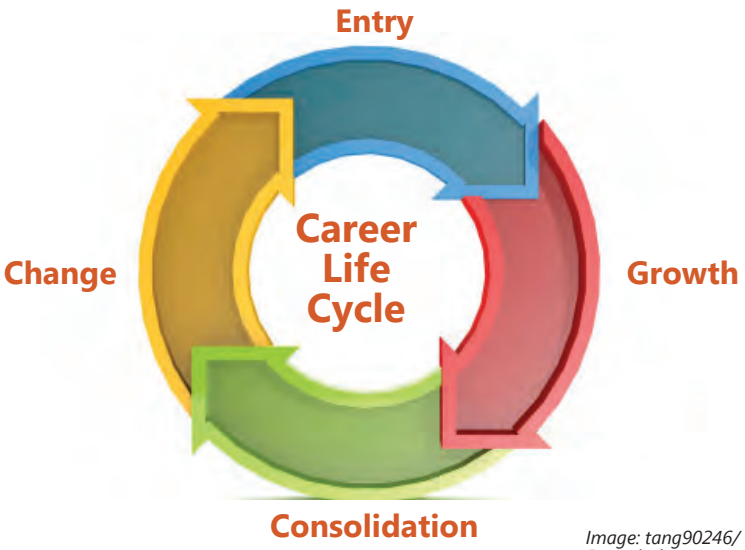

Image: tang90246/ Depositphotos.com

Career development & personal life

One of the most important ways to live a happy and healthy life is to match your personal **values** with your **career**.

An average person will spend about 40+ years of their adult life working. The demands of working life will dictate how much family, personal and leisure time is available.

You must strike a **work/life balance** between career demands and your personal life. At different stages of your life, your personal and family responsibilities will influence your ability to develop a career.

Many people develop career pathways in areas that don't suit their interests nor their values. As a result, they end up experiencing an unfulfilling work life.

Choosing a career that matches your values is likely to help you satisfy your personal goals. And that's what it's all about! Do you agree?

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Learning to learn

Vocational training utilises a mix of learning and training methods as part of lifelong learning.

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The notion of learning to learning is a key part of career pathways development. Essentially, this involves you being more able to proactively identify potential **career development opportunities**, as well as building a suite of skills to enable you to take advantage of learning and training opportunities.

To build your career, you are expected to actively undertake lifelong learning as part of your **personal** and **professional development**. If you take proactive steps to become better at learning to learn, then you are more likely to be **motivated**, to experience **career progression**, and to enjoy greater **job satisfaction**.

The key elements that can enhance your ability to learn are:

1. Understanding your preferred **learning styles**.
2. Being **interested** and **motivated**.
3. Building your **knowledge-base** (what) and your **skills-sets** (how).
4. Adopting an **attitude** that accepts that the more learning you do, the better you will become at learning.
5. Ongoing and active **participation** in **on-the-job** and **off-the-job lifelong learning** and **training**.

There are many ways that we can learn and be trained to develop **employability skills** and work-related **competencies**. Combinations of these suit various people, different tasks and varied circumstances. Many of these are shown below. Which of these suits you - and can you suggest others?

Learning to Learn

Image: Peter Mooy/ iStock/Thinkstock

Doing

Watching

Reading

What do you think are the best ways for youngsters to learn, is tech the answer?

Following

Listening

Modelling

Talking

Practising

Asking

Demonstrating

Discussing

Designing

Reflecting

Researching

Evaluating

Analysing

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8.03 Lifelong Learning

Lifelong learning

You've probably heard this before. But the message is even more relevant for you at this point in time, now that you are actively choosing your major career direction.

If you think that when you're finished with school you're finished with learning, then think again! A successful career pathway relies on lifelong learning. **Lifelong learning** refers to all the different types of study and training you might participate in throughout your career.

You need specific **qualifications** to enter certain occupations. However, you also need to maintain and upgrade your qualifications as your career evolves. This might involve TAFE, university, professional development, industry courses, etc..

For example, an electrician will have to complete an approved **Australian Apprenticeship** in order to be qualified and enter the occupation. Electricians will then have to undertake regular training throughout their career so as to maintain their qualification and to specialise in certain areas. This training will reflect changes and developments in technology, legislation, safety and other industry issues.

An accountant will have to complete a **university** degree to be recognised as a qualified accountant. Throughout their career they will undertake more training to keep abreast of changes in taxation, superannuation and other financial and legal issues. If they want to be a qualified CPA, they will also have to undertake further intensive study.

Keep on movin'

Life never stands still! Just when you get used to something, it changes. The same goes for work. No one participating in the modern workforce can complete their initial qualification and then expect to be set up in a job for life. Career success requires employees to participate in **lifelong learning**.

Advances in technology continually alter the structure of industry and the economy, and both **redundancies** and **skills shortages** can occur. As a result, workers must keep up to date with ongoing **professional development** and **training**.

Think of a motor mechanic who may have started their apprenticeship in the early 2000s. In the 25 or so years that have passed during their career, technological advancements in motor vehicles, computerised engines and EVs have drastically altered the **work skills** required of modern mechanics. And we might be talking about an employee who is only 40 years old (younger than some of your parents), and who still has more than half of their career ahead of them.

The world of work keeps evolving, and so too does the range of **skills-sets** required of workers. Workers need to upgrade their technical skills, industry-specific skills, professional skills, leadership skills and people skills.

And as we saw with the effects of the COVID-19 pandemic (remember that!), many people had to change career direction, and **up-skill** and **re-skill**, to build a new career in the altered post-pandemic world of work. Wonder how they're doing now?

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Keep on training

A **successful career pathway** relies on lifelong learning. **Lifelong learning** is all the different types of **education**, **training** and **learning** you might complete throughout your career.

As your **career progresses** into more **senior**, responsible and complex positions, you might be faced with a **new** set of **entry-level requirements** requiring new training challenges. e.g. Many middle-level managers are sent back to **TAFE** and **uni** to undertake financial and accounting training.

Australian Qualifications Framework		
School	**TAFE**	**University**
		doctoral degree
		masters degree
		graduate diploma
		graduate certificate
		bachelor degree
	advanced diploma	
	diploma	
	certificate 4	
senior secondary: WACE, VCE, HSC, SACE, QCE, TCE, NTCE	certificate 3	
	certificate 2	
	certificate 1	

As part of the **Australian Qualifications Framework** (AQF) a person can upgrade their qualification level to advance their career as part of lifelong learning.

One destination, many paths

When planning your future career pathway, it is important to realise that there is more than one way to get to where you want to be in life.

Many **entry-level jobs** can be accessed via **different methods**. Sure it is easier and faster to get accepted into your chosen career straight out of school, or based on the first job that you apply for. However, most people need to take a series of **career steps** to get to where they want to be, including different **work-related training** options.

Sometimes you might experience **roadblocks** that prevent you from achieving your career goals straight away. These might include a lack of training, a lack of experience, or a lack of available jobs, including Australian Apprenticeships.

To deal with these barriers, it is vital to have a series of **pathways options**. Your options can be broadened by exploring different methods of **on-the-job** and **off-the-job formal** and **informal training** that can help you.

Lifelong learning 8A

1. What is **lifelong learning**, and why is it **important**?

2. What **learning** and **training** do you think **you will need** over the next **1-3 years**?

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8.05 Training and Development

Education, training and development

Education and training are essential for developing a skilled workforce. Employees of all levels must be able to perform their job tasks effectively as collaborative workers. They also need to be well-trained and educated in the **industry-specific** and **technical skills** required in their job roles.

Flexibility and **adaptability** have never been more vital than in the contemporary world of work. Well-trained employees are usually **multi-skilled** and able to perform a variety of work tasks by being both **functionally** and **numerically flexible**.

To develop your **employability skills**, you will need to participate in education and training as part of ongoing **workplace learning**. As a result, you will become more **employable**. Doing this is part of developing a **growth mindset**.

Formal and informal education, training and development

All training and workplace learning can be classified as either formal or informal training.

On-the-job training and workplace learning usually happen at a worksite. It might be built into the regular tasks that the employee has to do. e.g. An office assistant might be expected to use the 'help' or an online tutorial to work out key functions of word-processing software. Or, they may be instructed by an experienced staff member.

Off-the-job training and workplace learning usually happen away from the worksite and may involve study for a formal qualification. e.g. The office assistant might undertake a short course in the use of Excel. Alternatively, they may be undertaking a TAFE certificate in a related field such as Business Administration. Many people go back to university later in life as they are promoted through an organisation.

Informal education and training usually occur on-the-job through supervision, mentoring, coaching, assistance, demonstration, modelling, feedback, advice and support. Informal training complements the more formal elements of education and training. It is usually directly related to how to do **job tasks** on a day-to-day basis.

Micro-credentials refer to short, focused courses, certifications or learning modules for specific skills or competencies. These are often industry-specific and targeted to meet the immediate demands of the **job role** or **labour market**. They tend to be more flexible, allowing employees to upskill or re-skill quickly. They can be earned through online platforms, training organisations, or be delivered by employers. Multiple credentials can also be combined into one 'larger' qualification.

People also learn informally in their **personal lives** by getting help from others, learning new **skills**, watching **online tutorials**, and **transferring** their personal aptitudes, skills and capabilities to work-related situations.

This type of skills development, where the learner uses their own **initiative**, helps to build both tangible and intangible skills as part of a growth mindset.

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Types of Training and Development

Formal training and development

- Training that leads to certification and qualifications.
- Formal training and development may be performed both on-the-job and off-the-job.
- Examples include VET, TAFE, Australian Apprenticeships, university and school education, as well as specific industry and technical training, such as getting a forklift license, a 'White Card' or completing an essential online e-learning WHS induction program.

On-the-job training and development

- Formal or informal training that takes place directly in the workplace.
- This is usually a normal part of learning and undertaking work tasks. e.g. CBT, direct supervision, etc..

Tradies will have to undergo ongoing training throughout their careers, including all of these types of training.

Off-the-job training and development

- This is training that takes place in a formal learning environment rather than in the 'everyday' workplace, and often leads to a certified outcome.
- e.g. TAFE, e-learning, etc..

Competency-based training

- CBT is learning based on demonstrating achievement of learning outcomes by performing specified tasks. e.g. Australian Apprenticeships.

Professional development

- Training opportunities for employees, often funded by employers, to help their workers upskill or re-skill so that they develop new skills and progress their careers.

Micro-credentials

- These include short, focused courses or learning modules for specific skills or competencies. They are often industry-specific and meet the immediate needs of a job role.

Informal training and development

- Informal education and training is training and workplace learning that doesn't directly result in a qualification.
- However, informal education and training can be equally important in the development of tangible skills.
- Informal training usually occurs on-the-job. This includes supervision, mentoring, day-to-day assistance, demonstration, advice and support.
- Sometimes informal education and training involve learning to learn, which helps a person to develop their transferable skills.

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8.07 Training and Development

Industry-specific skills

As you know, **industry-specific skills** refer to particular skills (or competencies) that an individual must demonstrate for a specific occupation within an industry. Many of these industry-specific skills are closely related to **employability skills**. But industry-specific skills require a worker to develop **specialised task knowledge** for occupations and work tasks directly for their industry of employment.

To successfully complete a task, a person must be **competent** in the specific requirements of that task. **Training packages** include units of competency that are developed by industry to meet the specific skill needs of that industry. For example, in the Construction industry, a roofer would need to know how to use technology. Specifically for this industry, this may include hand and power tools, safety harnesses, and measuring tools and equipment.

Technical skills

Technical skills are vital for success in the contemporary world of work. All occupations within all industries rely on the appropriate and safe use of **technology** by workers.

Think of the day-to-day duties of a nurse, a plumber, a firefighter, a truck driver and a farm worker. Lots of very different industry-specific technical requirements there. And what about a pastry chef, a hairdresser, a multimedia developer, a fitness instructor and an ICT technician. Again, lots of very different technical skills required by each occupation.

All occupations require some level of **practical**, **manual** and **technical expertise**. However, there are certain occupations that are very technical and/or scientific in nature. These include all the medical and health roles, trades, manufacturing, outdoor work, anything involving tools, equipment and machinery; and of course all the workers involved in ICT, engineering, design, and heavy industry - just to name a few.

Some common technical **job tasks** and **operations** include these listed below. So do any of these sound like your own **personal skills**, **attributes** and **capabilities**?

Image: tonodiaz/ Depositphotos.com

Technical skills

- Using and managing automated and mechanical processes and systems.
- Applying physical skills, manual dexterity and eye-hand coordination to complete tasks.
- Knowing industry-specific technical terms.
- Operating vehicles and mobile equipment.
- Combining ingredients, inputs and components.
- Assembling inputs, components and equipment.
- Identifying sequences, patterns and systems.
- Developing, creating and following systems and processes.
- Designing, creating and making items and products.
- Safely using hand tools, implements and equipment.
- Safely using powered tools, equipment and machinery.
- Using analogue and digital measuring devices and tools.
- Using digital communication devices.
- Following product specifications and safety guidelines.
- Mastering ethical use of Artificial Intelligence.

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Competency-based training

The most common way that people develop industry-specific skills is by undertaking vocational training.

Competency-based training (**CBT**) refers to vocational learning based on demonstrating achievement of learning outcomes by performing specified tasks.

Competency-based training is used in qualifications offered through **vocational training**, **VET**, apprenticeships and traineeships via the **Australian Apprenticeship** system, as well as other forms of both on-the-job and off-the-job training.

In order to successfully complete a competency-based training package, a trainee must satisfy the **learning outcomes** of that training package, similar to getting a passing grade in a WACE Unit.

Each qualification under a training package consists of a number of **units of competence**.

Under competency-based training, there is no fixed or set time for completion. Competency-based training is, in essence, **self-paced**. As the trainee completes a unit of competency, this is 'ticked-off'.

Training will take place both on-the-job, and off-the-job at 'trade school' at a TAFE or RTO.

Image: Goodluz/ Depositphotos.com

Training packages

Training packages are sets of nationally endorsed standards and qualifications for recognising and assessing people's skills. Training packages include the industry-specific skills required of an apprentice, or a trainee, or a student, undertaking vocational learning.

A training package sets out the requirements for both on-the-job and off-the-job structured training.

Training packages include relevant **competency standards**. These describe the required skills and knowledge needed for a trainee to operate effectively in the workplace.

Competency standards in training packages are recognised Australia-wide. They form the basis of training for a specific industry.

To successfully complete a qualification, a trainee must complete all **units of competence** (core and elective) in a qualification.

This is achieved by completing all of the **elements** that make up each unit of competency; and by satisfying each of the **performance criteria** in each element.

Image: monkeybusiness/ Depositphotos.com

Workplace assessors will assess your competency against the performance criteria for the elements in the training package.

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8.09 Training and Development

Researching Industry-Specific Skills

The best site to use to find out about industry-specific skills (and competencies) is:

https://training.gov.au

It is a huge official information site and does take some getting used to at first.

- ⇨ Go to **Keyword search** near the top.
- ⇨ **Enter a job name** and then **Search**.
- ⇨ From the NRT menu choose **Current**.
- ⇨ Select a suitable course by clicking on the **course code** (current not superseded).
- ⇨ Scroll down to see all the core units and the elective units.

Get familiar with these for your occupation and qualification level.

- ⇨ Scroll back up and choose from the **Units of Competency (click on course code).**
- ⇨ Scroll down and you can see all the **Elements** required for that unit.

Next to these are all the **Performance Criteria**. These are industry-specific.

- ⇨ You can scroll down again to see the **Assessment requirements**.

Both the **Knowledge Evidence** and the **Assessment Conditions** give even more insight into industry-specific competencies.

Your teacher may guide the class through this process using a common industry training package, such as **Retail Operations** or **Kitchen Operations.**

8B Training and development

1. What is the difference between **formal** and **informal training**? How would both of **these** be **relevant** for your future career?

2. How does **on-the-job** training usually happen? Give 2 different examples. Describe instances of **on-the-job** training **you** have **participated** in.

3. How does **off-the-job** training usually happen? Give 2 different examples. Describe instances of **off-the-job** training **you** have **participated in**.

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4. Describe **employability skills** that you have developed in **non-work situations**. How **could you transfer**, or how **have you** transferred, these skills to **work-related situations**?

5. Describe **industry-specific skills** that you have developed in **non-work situations**. How **could you transfer**, or how **have you** transferred, these skills to **work-related situations**?

6. Describe **technical skills** that you have developed in **non-work situations**. How **could you transfer**, or how **have you** transferred, these skills to **work-related situations**?

Investigation: Use **https://training.gov.au** to research a training package that matches an industry or occupation that you are interested in. Create a table using these prompts for the information you can find out.

Occupation(s)	Industry(ies)
Title, level & code	Licensing/regulatory information
Entry requirements	Packaging rules
Core units	Elective units

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Pathways to Success

Lifelong learning is essential to keep abreast of the changes required in one's employment. Occupations as varied as chefs, doctors, plumbers, hairdressers, engineers and retail managers undergo regular training, either through on-the-job or off-the-job courses offered by a range of different training providers.

Lifelong learning is also essential if you are thinking about advancing your career or changing direction. A change in career direction might see you return to study. This might be in a formal training course part-time at TAFE or university to advance your career, or to get a promotion, or to move into a management role. Many people also need to return to study to learn business, finance and management skills as they get promoted into more senior roles.

Doing training courses or undertaking formal qualifications has become a routine part of being in the workforce. As an employee, you are required to quickly learn and adapt to changing technologies and work practices. Formal training is often required as part of legal guidelines, licensing and WHS.

You might also be surprised to know that many adults who have been in the workforce for many years see participating in further study as an adventure and an opportunity to keep them fresh and interested in life.

So, do you think that you'd need to learn anything new to update your skills between now and 2070? That's right - 2070!

Frederica N'rkette

Frederica wasn't the most academic student at school, but she always did all her work and got her WACE, including CEM. She also completed VET Certificate 3 in Business (Office Admin).

Her admin skills helped her land a part-time job in a legal office which meant she could quit her checkout job at Mad Mogy'z Discount Bazaar. She was accepted into a TAFE certificate IV in Administration and completed this quickly.

After her course she got a traineeship, helped by her past experience, with a local 'green' carpet manufacturing company and was essentially the back-up office person. Although her trainee wage was lower than many of her friends who were working casual jobs, Frederica really enjoyed the chance to learn all the work tasks required to run the office, as well as the responsibility she was given.

When her office manager went on maternity leave, Frederica, now 21, was given the office manager role. Soon after this, the company landed a government supply contract and expanded rapidly. The CEO wanted Frederica to run the administration department, so he sent her to University part-time to obtain a degree in administration.

"...When her office manager went on maternity leave, Frederica, now 21, was given the office manager role."

This made her long-time partner very proud of her. Her previous training and experience were taken into account and reduced the time she needed to complete her studies. Frederica, combining part-time work and study paid for by her boss, was now successfully supervising a department of seven people.

By the time she was 30, Frederica was the Head of Administration in a company that employed over 120 people. When shopping one day, she saw one of those same former classmates working at Spiceline. Frederica asked,

"So you must be managing the store?"
Unfortunately, the reply was,

"No; I'm still only casual!"

Frederica was really happy to have her career in order and thought that it might be time to combine her career and a family.

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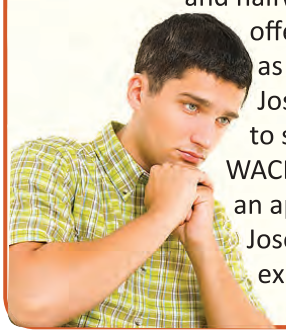
Joseph Borg

Joseph didn't really mind being at school, but he didn't like the theory classes too much because he was told he had too much 'nervous energy' - anyway he would rather have been up and about, fixing things. Joseph did well in his practical classes and really wanted to be a mechanic of some sort. He studied VET Automotive as part of his WACE and enjoyed CEM, especially because the school had set it up so that he could do some workplace learning.

Joseph's boss was impressed by his enthusiasm and halfway through Year 11 offered him an apprenticeship as a motor mechanic. But Joseph's mum wanted him to stay at school and finish his WACE, so Joseph's boss hired an apprentice which meant Joseph also lost his work experience placement.



Joseph got a different placement working at RealCheap Auto and while there, a client of his former boss, recognised him as that 'work experience kid' who was always keen and full of energy.

He offered him a paid trial in his light-engine reconditioning business, servicing outboards, motorcycles, other small engines and modifying wheelchairs. His school helped set up the trial. Joseph did really well, and after a meeting with teachers, the careers teacher and his coordinator, Joseph's mother agreed to him finishing Year 11 and then taking the apprenticeship.

5 years later, Joseph's teacher saw him on the news as a winner of a community young leader award. Joseph was now running an organisation that was sponsored by companies to 'hot up' and modify wheelchairs for disabled kids.

Who would've thought it back when he couldn't sit still in English!

Pathways to success 8C

1. Describe 3 potential **benefits** of **lifelong learning** for **your** own **career** pathways development.

2. Choose **one** of the 'Pathway to Success' **profiles** and then answer the following questions.
   a. Outline the person's key **skills** and **strengths**.
   b. List the **occupations** and **roles** that the person undertook, and identify the types of **training** they needed to complete for each of these roles.
   c. Describe some of the **obstacles** that the person had to **overcome**. How did they deal with these?
   d. Describe the **values** and/or the **actions** that **helped** the person to develop a successful pathway.

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8.13 Continuing Professional Development

Continuing professional development

Throughout your career you will experience ongoing **on-the-job** and **off-the-job learning** and **training**. But if you want to truly leverage this **professional development** into **career** evolution and **growth**, you need to identify and consolidate the benefits that arise from your professional development. You will be better placed to develop professionally at all stages of your career, by proactively applying these five elements as part of your own career and skills growth, reflection and review.

1. **Identifying personal needs**
2. **Planning and participating in learning opportunities**
3. **Reflecting on learning**
4. **Applying learning**
5. **Sharing learning with others**

Continuing Professional Development

1. Identifying personal needs

Could involve: Recognising gaps in your skills, knowledge or experience that could hold you back, and deciding what you need to improve.
e.g. You realise you're struggling to use spreadsheet formulae during shift planning in a café, so you identify digital literacy as an area to build.

Why it matters: Identifying learning needs early on helps you set goals, choose training that suits your path, and stay employable in a changing workforce.

How identifying personal needs might help...

- ⇨ **post-Year 12**: You realise you need better communication skills to handle customer complaints confidently.
- ⇨ **in 2–3 years, after formal training**: You identify that your leadership and delegation skills need strengthening before applying for a team leader role.
- ⇨ **5 years on**: You want to specialise in management of logistics, so you assess gaps in your data and software skills to plan your next learning steps.

2. Planning and participating in learning opportunities

Could involve: Making a plan to gain new skills, then actively taking part in training, whether it's through a course, mentoring, or learning on the job.
e.g. After feeling unsure during a heated customer complaint, you realise you need to improve your conflict resolution and communication skills.

Why it matters: Taking part in learning opportunities helps you stay current, adapt to changes, and show initiative in your own development.

How planning and participating in learning opportunities might help...

- ⇨ **post-Year 12**: You do an online conflict resolution module to prepare for casual front-line work.
- ⇨ **in 2–3 years, after formal training**: After being given more responsibility with junior staff, you complete an external workplace communication professional development program.
- ⇨ **5 years on**: You begin a part-time TAFE advanced diploma in leadership that includes managing conflict in team environments.

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3. Reflecting on learning

Could involve: Thinking about what you've learned, how it went, and how this might improve your performance in the future.
e.g. After struggling to meet a deadline for a group project, you reflect on what went wrong, ask for advice on managing your time better, and plan a new approach for your next project.

Why it matters: Reflecting helps you to understand what worked, to identify knowledge and skills gaps, and how to improve how you apply your knowledge and skills.

How reflecting on learning might help...

- ⇨ **post-Year 12**: After learning to manage stress in busy situations you realise how much less-pressured your job becomes.
- ⇨ **in 2–3 years**, **after formal training**: You reflect on feedback from your employee evaluation, and use it to refine your approach to daily tasks.
- ⇨ **5 years on**: You look back on your career so far, and identify where further learning or upskilling could help you develop.

4. Applying learning

Could involve: Putting new knowledge, training or skills into action in real work or life situations.
e.g. After completing a first-aid course, you are able to confidently assist and comfort a co-worker who has a minor injury, while waiting for medical help to arrive.

Why it matters: Naturally, applying what you've learned helps build confidence, shows initiative and turns theory into practical results.

How applying learning might help...

- ⇨ **post-Year 12**: You apply what you learned in a WHS course while working on a construction site, ensuring tools are stored correctly and hazards are reported immediately.
- ⇨ **in 2–3 years**, **after formal training**: You use your conflict resolution training to calmly handle a difficult customer situation.
- ⇨ **5 years on**: You apply your budgeting and planning skills to manage and lead a small team through a work project.

5. Sharing learning with others

Could involve: Helping others by passing on what you've learned, either informally, or through mentoring, training or demonstration.
e.g. After learning a faster and safer way to prep vegetables during kitchen service, you show a new team member the technique - and explain how all the scraps go into making the soup special of the day!

Why it matters: Sharing knowledge supports teamwork, builds leadership skills and creates a more capable and efficient workplace.

How sharing learning with others might help...

- ⇨ **post-Year 12**: You show a new co-worker how to use the register correctly and offer tips for speeding up service.
- ⇨ **in 2–3 years**, **after formal training**: You mentor a first-year apprentice, and help an older colleague understand a new digital system introduced at work.
- ⇨ **5 years on**: You run a short training session to upskill your team on a new workplace app or process.

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8.15 Continuing Professional Development

8D Continuing professional development

Describe how each of the **5 elements** of **continuing professional development** might **apply** to **your career development**. Strongly consider getting **advice** from your CEM teacher, Careers Advisor or a career mentor to guide you.

Could involve...	Why it matters...	How it might help...		
		Post-Year 12	In 2-3 years	In 5+ years
1. Identifying personal needs				
2. Planning and participating in learning opportunities				
3. Reflecting on learning				
4. Applying learning				
5. Sharing learning with others				

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Career development - Insights 8E

Interview **3 workers** who are at **different stages** of their **career** (i.e. entry/still in study, mid-20s, and 30+). If you work, one of them could be you. Consider a worker who is doing (or has done) an Australian Apprenticeship if that matches your career pathways goals. Find out the information below in relation to their current employment. Ask for advice based on their career development experiences.

Worker/Job/Age	
Employer/ Worksite	
Formal qualifica-tions gained	
Education/ training prior to career	
Other training completed	
For current job...	
On-the-job training undertaken	
Off-the-job training undertaken	
Any other training/ learning e.g. PD, micro-credentials	
Qualifications gained	
Impact on career development	
What's next for them?	
Advice for you	

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8.17 Assessment Task 1a

AT1a Lifelong Learning Plan - My Investigation // Learning and work exploration

For this Unit 4 **Investigation** assessment task, you will complete both:

- ☐ **AT1a: Lifelong Learning Plan - My Investigation** (p.202); and
- ☐ **AT1b: Enterprise Culture and Being Enterprising** (p.224).

Requirements - AT1a: Lifelong Learning Plan - My Investigation

For this assessment task, you are required to research, prepare, present and discuss a **Lifelong learning Plan**. Your teacher will outline your specific requirements and the format and dates for completion. You should combine text, image-based, diagram and varied media to set out your information and communicate your Lifelong Learning Plan.

Your **Lifelong Learning Plan** is an evolving document and should include the following.

a. Statement of your **career pathways goals**, including **short-term**, **mid-term** and **long-term** goals.
b. Development of an overall **action plan** including short-term, mid-term and long-term **milestones** and **timelines** for **achievement**.
c. Outline of the **steps** needed **to achieve** your career pathways **goals**, including **timelines**.
d. Outline of further **study**, **training** and **courses** required within each of the **timeframes**.
e. Clarification of the **application process** for **further study**, **training** and **courses**.
f. Clarification of **potential costs** and **fees** for **further study**, **training** and **courses**.
g. Summary of **meetings** and **advice** from at least **2** of the following: Careers Advisor, CEM Teacher, Career Mentor, family member, community leader.
h. Predict how **future changes** might **impact** on the **achievement** of your **goals**.
i. Establishment of a **back-up option**(s) or a Plan B.
j. Final **discussion** for **feedback** on your **Lifelong Learning Plan**. Use and apply feedback and advice to **finalise** your **Lifelong Learning Plan**.

Name:		**Key dates:**			**UNIT 4 AT1a**
AT1a: Lifelong Learning Plan - My Investigation		**Must Do?**	**Due Date**	**Done**	**Level**
a.	Career pathways goals, inc. short, mid & long-term goals.	✓		○	
b.	Overall action plan and timelines for achievement.	✓		○	
c.	Steps to achieve career pathways goals & timelines.	✓		○	
d.	Further study, training & courses required.	✓		○	
e.	Application process for further study, training and courses.	✓		○	
f.	Potential costs of further study, training and courses.	✓		○	
g.	Summaries of advice from at least 2 people.	✓		○	
h.	Future changes and how these might impact on goals.	✓		○	
i.	Establishment of a back-up option.	✓		○	
j.	Use and apply feedback advice to finalise your plan.	✓		○	
	Present your final Lifelong Learning Plan (as required).	✓		○	

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CAREERS AND EMPLOYABILITY

CEM G12

Unit 3

1. Skills For Work 1
2. Personal Management 19
3. Personal Financial Management 47
4. Labour Market 71
5. Job Applications 107
6. Changing Nature of Work 139

Unit 4

7. Resilience and Feedback 163
8. Lifelong Learning 185
9. Enterprise Culture 203
10. Job Interviews 225
11. Career Building 249
12. Legislation and Employment 273
13. Work Conditions / Grievances 307

Disclaimer: All material is provided in good faith but it is the responsibility of students and teachers to check current and appropriate guidelines, assessment information and publications.

Important: All material, advice and assessment tasks are provided as a guide only and do not constitute official advice. As always you must check with the School Curriculum and Standards Authority and any other relevant authorities about the suitability of a task.

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